

Incident Response and Recovery Checklist

What to do first after a suspected malware infection, account exposure, or scam.

Audience	Families dealing with a suspicious event or recent mistake.
Purpose	Give calm recovery steps and reduce additional harm.
Best use	Use from a clean device when possible.

Do this first

☐	Disconnect the suspicious device from the internet if needed.
☐	Do not enter new passwords on a device that may be compromised.
☐	From a clean device, change the email password first.
☐	Enable multifactor authentication.
☐	Check recent logins and sign out of unknown sessions.
☐	Call the bank or card issuer if money or payment data may be involved.

Clean and recover

☐	Run a built in security scan.
☐	Apply updates.
☐	Remove suspicious apps or browser extensions.
☐	Restore files from backup if needed.
☐	Save screenshots and notes for reporting.

Do not do this

☐	Do not share codes with a caller.
☐	Do not allow remote access because a pop up told you to.
☐	Do not pay a stranger who claims they can remove a virus.

Keep this guide near the device or account it protects. Small habits make a real difference when they are repeated.